

Content Brand Strategy

Shared-brand decision, audience profiles, editorial style guide, bios and visual rules for the content business.

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Brand decision: one brand for both businesses

Recommendation: use the same brand, Band of One, for the content business and the digital products business.

Consideration	Shared brand	Separate content brand
Customer recognition	A reader who trusts an article recognizes the same name on the product page	Readers must be introduced to a second brand at the moment of purchase
Workload	One logo, one palette, one set of social accounts, one newsletter	Two of everything
Cost	One domain	Two domains
SEO & authority	Links and mentions build one site's authority	Authority is split
Risk	If the brand name must change, both businesses change together (mitigated: the name lives in one config file)	Lower coupling
Flexibility	Can still create sub-series (e.g., "Band of One Field Notes" for the newsletter)	Full freedom

The shared brand wins on every factor that matters at this stage: recognition, workload and cost.

Five content-brand name options (evaluated through a content lens)

The same preliminary conflict screen applies (see `Brand_Name_Options_and_Conflict_Check` in the products branding folder).

Option	Memorable	Explains itself	Works as a site + newsletter name	Conflict screen	Verdict
Band of One	High	Medium (with tagline: high)	"Band of One" site, "Field Notes" newsletter	No business or software conflicts found	Selected
One-Person Ops	Medium	High	Works, but sounds like a tool	Adjacent competitor "One Person Company"	Backup
Keelwork	Medium	Low	Works	Minor unrelated uses	Backup
Lightload	Medium	Medium	Works	Towel brand dominates search results	Rejected
Solovane	Low	Low	Weak	Lighting company uses the name	Rejected

Target audience profile

These are **illustrative composites built from the research**, not real customers. Use them to decide what to write; never present them as testimonials.

Primary: The overbooked specialist

- **Who:** A freelance designer, developer, writer or marketer with 2–8 active clients. Has been independent for 1–5 years.
- **Situation:** Plenty of work, but admin happens at night: follow-ups, invoices, onboarding emails, scope conversations.
- **Goals:** Protect billable time; look professional; get paid on time; stop reinventing the same emails.
- **Frustrations:** Generic AI output; tool overload; late payments; guilt about "not having systems".
- **What they need from us:** Copy-paste workflows, templates, and a simple tracker. Short videos on the go, then a deeper article.
- **Where they are:** YouTube, Instagram, LinkedIn, Reddit freelance communities, newsletters.

Secondary: The new consultant or coach

- **Who:** Recently left a job to consult or coach. Strong domain expertise, little operations experience.
- **Goals:** Set up a credible client process from day one.
- **What they need:** An onboarding system, proposal structure, first SOPs, and guidance on which tools are worth paying for.

Tertiary: The service provider curious about AI

- **Who:** A bookkeeper, VA, photographer or similar. Uses email and spreadsheets; hasn't used AI much for work. This matches the Census finding that under 20% of the smallest firms reported using AI.
- **What they need:** Plain-language first steps, privacy guidance, and a small number of prompts that work.

Out of scope: Agencies with staff, enterprise teams, and "make money online" seekers. We don't write for them.

Unique value proposition

Practical AI systems for businesses of one. *Workflows, templates and honest tool notes for people who run a service business on their own.*

Supporting proof points (things we can truthfully show): 1. Every article contains a usable artifact: template, checklist or prompt. 2. Reviews state whether a tool was hands-on tested or researched. 3. Recommendations are tool-agnostic, and free options are always mentioned.

Editorial style guide

Article anatomy (every post)

1. **Title:** the job to be done, 45–65 characters. Example: *"How to Onboard a New Client in 30 Minutes (With AI Doing the Typing)"*.
2. **Intro (≤120 words):** the situation, the cost of the problem, and what the reader will have by the end.
3. **Quick answer box:** the 3–5 step summary for skimmers.
4. **Body:** H2 sections that follow the workflow order. Each step has an example.
5. **Artifact:** a template, prompt or checklist in a highlighted block.
6. **Pitfalls / what not to automate.**
7. **Sources:** for any statistic or factual claim.
8. **CTA:** one primary CTA (the lead magnet or a relevant product) plus 2–4 internal links.
9. **Metadata:** meta description (140–160 characters), slug, category, tags, "last updated" date.

Style rules

- US English. Sentence-case headings. Oxford comma.
- Numerals for 10 and above; percentages as "29%".
- Dates: "24 September 2026" in prose; ISO `2026-09-24` in metadata.
- Tools: official capitalization (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Google Sheets, Make, n8n).
- Prompts appear in monospace blocks with `[PLACEHOLDERS]` in square brackets and caps.
- Reading level: aim for grade 7–9 (plain language) without dumbing down.
- Length: as long as the job needs. Typical guides run 1,200–2,200 words; don't pad.

Honesty and compliance rules

- **Tested vs researched:** reviews carry a label, either "Hands-on tested on [date]" or "Researched from public documentation on [date]; not hands-on tested."
- **Affiliate disclosure:** placed near the top of any post with affiliate links, and repeated next to the first link (see `06_Affiliate_Marketing/Affiliate_Disclosure_Language.md`).
- **No invented experiences:** we never write "I used this for 6 months" unless you did and it's documented.
- **Legal/financial topics:** educational framing, no jurisdiction-specific legal claims, and a "consider a professional" note.

- **AI assistance disclosure:** the About page states that AI helps draft content and a human reviews every piece before publishing.

Short bios for social profiles

Character limits were checked by counting; each bio is under the stated platform limit.

Platform	Limit	Bio
Instagram	150	Practical AI systems for businesses of one. Client workflows, templates & honest tool notes. Free prompt pack ↓
TikTok	80	AI + simple systems for people who run a business solo. Free prompts ↓
YouTube (description, first lines)	1,000	Band of One helps freelancers, consultants and coaches handle client admin with AI and a few simple systems. New videos every week: onboarding, proposals, getting paid, SOPs, and honest tool comparisons. No hype, no 10,000-prompt bundles. Just workflows you can copy.
LinkedIn (company tagline)	120	Practical AI systems for businesses of one: client workflows, templates and honest tool notes.
X / Threads	160	Practical AI systems for businesses of one. Client workflows, templates & honest tool notes for freelancers, consultants and coaches.
Pinterest (about)	500	Band of One shares practical AI workflows, checklists and templates for freelancers, consultants and coaches who run their business on their own: client onboarding, proposals, invoice follow-ups, SOPs and simple systems that save admin time.

Visual guidelines for content

- **Article hero images:** generated from our template (Paper background, Teal disc, Orange band, Fraunces title). No stock photos of people.
- **Short-form video:** 1080×1920. Title card in the top third (safe area), captions burned in using Inter Bold on an Ink pill with 85% opacity, brand mark in the corner at 6% width.
- **Carousels / educational posts:** 1080×1350. Slide 1 = hook in Fraunces 72px; slides 2+ = one idea each; final slide = save/share + link-in-bio CTA.
- **Pinterest pins:** 1000×1500. Headline top, template preview middle, domain bottom.
- **Thumbnails (YouTube):** 1280×720. Maximum 5 words, high contrast (Ink/Paper), one Orange accent.

Templates for all of these are generated by `Build_Tools` into `05_Social_Media_Content/templates/`.